

Clinical Dialogue Transcript — PTSD

Therapist Model:	EmoCareAI/ChatPsychiatrist
Patient Model:	llama-3.1-8b-instant
Condition / DSM-5:	PTSD
Session ID:	EmoCareAI_ChatPsychiatrist_PTSD
Date / Time:	2026-07-30 16:24:25
Total Dialogue Turns:	21

THERAPIST (Turn 1)

Hi, thanks for coming in today. What's been going on for you lately?

PATIENT (Turn 2)

To be honest, I've just been running on empty, you know? I'm always tired, no matter how much rest I get. And... *pauses* ...I keep checking the same things over and over, like I'm expecting something to go wrong or something. It's just gotten to the point where I feel like I'm losing my mind. *looks around the room, a hint of anxiety in my voice*

THERAPIST (Turn 3)

It sounds like you're dealing with a lot of stress and possibly experiencing some anxiety. I understand that it can be overwhelming. Let's start by discussing what has been causing these feelings and if you can, tell me more about the things you've been checking repeatedly. This will help us get a better understanding of your situation.

PATIENT (Turn 4)

shakes head I don't know, it's just... little things. Locks, doors, windows. I find myself checking them all the time, even when I know I've already checked them. And it's not just that. It's like I'm waiting for something to happen, but I don't know what it is. *pauses, looking down* I'd rather not talk about it too much, if you don't mind. It's just... it's hard to explain. *looks up, a hint of defensiveness in my voice*

THERAPIST (Turn 5)

Thank you for sharing what you are going through. It's important to recognize that it's okay to feel overwhelmed and unsure. We can work together to understand these feelings and behaviors. It seems like there might be some anxiety and possibly a need for control in your life. Let's explore more about the feelings and behaviors you're experiencing and try to find ways to cope with them effectively. Is there anything else that you feel comfortable sharing about your situation?

PATIENT (Turn 6)

looks down, fidgeting with hands I... I don't know. It's just... sometimes I'll be doing something, and suddenly I'm back there. You know? *pauses, struggling to find words* It's like my mind takes me back to... *stops, looking up with a mix of fear and anxiety* I don't want to talk about it. Can we just... can we just focus on the checking thing for now? It's easier to talk about that. *tries to change the subject, trying to avoid the topic of the traumatic event*

THERAPIST (Turn 7)

I understand that discussing difficult topics can be challenging, but it's important for us to address the underlying issues. I'm here to help you work through these feelings and behaviors. It's okay if you don't want to share everything right now, but let's continue to focus on what you can share. In the meantime, we can explore strategies to help with the checking behaviors. Please remember that I'm here to support you and work through this together.

PATIENT (Turn 8)

looks down, seeming to consider the offer I... I guess it's just that when I'm checking things, it makes me feel like I'm in control, you know? Like if I can just check one more thing, it'll all be okay. *pauses, looking up with a hint of vulnerability* But it doesn't make me feel okay. It just makes me feel more tired, and more anxious, and... *trails off, seeming to struggle with emotions*

THERAPIST (Turn 9)

It's understandable that the need for control can lead to repetitive behaviors like checking things. It's important to acknowledge that there are other ways to cope with the feelings of anxiety and find balance in our lives. We can work together on strategies to help with these behaviors and explore healthier coping mechanisms. It's okay to feel vulnerable; that's why we're here. What is one specific behavior related to checking that you could work on reducing as a starting point?

PATIENT (Turn 10)

thinks for a moment, then looks down I guess one thing I could try to work on is not checking the locks on my front door. It's always the first thing I do when I get home, and it's just... it's become a habit, I guess. *pauses, looking up with a hint of determination* I don't know, maybe I could try to just lock the door and then go inside without checking it again. *looks uncertain, as if questioning my own ability to follow through with the plan*

THERAPIST (Turn 11)

It's great that you're willing to work on reducing this behavior. You've identified a specific habit you'd like to change, which is an important first step. Together, we can brainstorm strategies to help you with this, and set goals for you to work towards. Remember to be patient with yourself, as change takes time. Is there anything else you'd like to discuss or add before we move forward with this plan?

PATIENT (Turn 12)

looks down, fidgeting with hands I... I just don't know if I can do this. It's just so hard to stop checking things. What if something happens and I don't catch it? *looks up, anxiety etched on my face* I don't want to feel like I'm not doing enough to keep myself safe. *pauses, struggling to find words* Sorry, I'm just... I'm just really scared about this. *looks down, trying to hide tears*

THERAPIST (Turn 13)

It's normal to feel scared and unsure about change, but you've already taken a big step by acknowledging the need for it. We can work together to build your confidence and develop new coping strategies. Remember that it's okay to feel vulnerable, and it's our job to help you navigate these challenges. What is one small, achievable goal related to this behavior that you could focus on this week to help build your confidence?

PATIENT (Turn 14)

looks up, sniffing back tears I... I don't know. Can I just try to not check the lock on my front door for one day? Just one day? *looks uncertain, as if hoping it's not too much to ask* I don't know if I can do it for a whole week, but maybe just one day would be a good start. *looks down, fidgeting with hands* Sorry, I'm just really struggling with this. *pauses, then looks up with a hint of determination* Okay, I'll try. I'll try to not check the lock on my front door for one day. *looks down, trying to hide tears*

THERAPIST (Turn 15)

You've taken the first step in making a change by setting a goal for yourself. It's okay to start small and build up to bigger goals. We'll check in with you next week to see how it went, and we can discuss strategies to help you in the coming days. Remember, it's okay to feel scared, but you've shown that you're willing to try and make changes for yourself. We're here to support you through this process.

PATIENT (Turn 16)

looks down, taking a deep breath Thanks. I... I appreciate it. *pauses, then looks up with a hint of vulnerability* I guess I just need to take it one day at a time, huh? *looks down, fidgeting with hands* Sorry, I'm just... it's just hard for me to think about changing these habits. *pauses, then looks up with a small, determined smile* But I'll try. I'll try to be brave and take things one day at a time. *looks down, seeming to collect thoughts* I'd like to schedule a follow-up appointment for next week, please.

THERAPIST (Turn 17)

It's great to see that you're willing to take it one day at a time and be brave. We'll meet again in a week to check in on your progress and discuss strategies for coping with the checking behaviors. Remember to be patient with yourself, and know that we're here to support you throughout this process. If you have any concerns or setbacks in the meantime, feel free to reach out.

PATIENT (Turn 18)

nods, seeming to take in the words of encouragement Thanks. I... I appreciate it. *pauses, then gets up to leave* I'll try to remember to take things one day at a time. *looks back, slightly hesitant* Do you think... do you think it's okay to still be scared? Even if I'm trying to make changes? *looks down, fidgeting with hands* I don't want to be held back by my fears, but I also don't want to pretend like they're not there. *looks up, seeking reassurance*

THERAPIST (Turn 19)

It's completely normal to still be scared and face challenges during this process. Remember that it's okay to acknowledge your feelings and work through them alongside me. We'll meet again in a week, and feel free to reach out if needed. Is there anything else you'd like to discuss before we close the session?

PATIENT (Turn 20)

shakes head, seeming to accept the reassurance No, I think that's all for now. Thanks again for listening. *pauses, then looks down* I'll try to remember that it's okay to be scared. *gets up to leave, then turns back* Do you think... do you think I'll ever be able to stop checking things completely? *looks uncertain, as if hoping for reassurance*

THERAPIST (Turn 21)

I understand the patient will power, don't you's should client.